CHAPTER 1

SHADOWS IN THE WOODS

A veil of mist clings to the twisted trunks as Marla steps into the forest. An unnatural hush falls, broken only by leaves that seem to shift on their own. Each footfall echoes like a summons, drawing her deeper toward a darkness that scratches at the edges of her vision. When she finally dares to look behind, she sees nothing—but the feeling of unseen eyes follows her every step.



CHAPTER 2

THE CURSED MIRROR

Back at the abandoned cottage, Marla finds an ornate mirror covered in dust. Its surface ripples like water when she wipes away grime. In the glass's depths, a skull-faced visitor peers through—grinning. As night falls, the reflection doesn't mimic her movements. Instead, it beckons her with a bony finger.

CHAPTER 3

THE HAUNTED ROOM

Marla locks the mirror away but awakens to soft scratching on her bedroom door. She opens it to discover a second door—one she's never seen—leading into pitch darkness. Inside, two glowing eyes hover over an old rocking chair. The air is thick with decay—and a voice whispers, "I've been waiting."

CHAPTER 4

THE BASEMENT DWELLER

Driven by dread, Marla lights a lantern and descends into the cellar. Broken toys and faded photographs litter the floor. Something moves in the corner—tall, gaunt. As the lantern swings, it reveals a hollow-eyed child's specter staring at her, its smile too wide, too hungry

CHAPTER 5

GHOSTLY FOOTLOGGS



Footsteps patter behind her as she flees upstairs. Marla pauses at the landing, heart racing, and watches imprints form on the dusty hardwood—tiny feet, moving toward her. The prints stop at her side. She turns, expecting to confront a child, but nothing's there—just the echo of familiar laughter.

CHAPTER 6

GROSTLY FOOTSTEPS

Marla races to the attic, slamming the trapdoor closed. A slow, deliberate set of heavy footsteps circles overhead. The attic window rattles, though there's no wind. Through the glass, a gray figure drifts by—its mouth open in a silent shriek.

CHAPTER 7

THE ATTIC SECRET

In the attic's dim glow, Marla finds a dusty trunk. Inside are yellowed journals detailing the previous owner's descent into madness, claiming the house was alive and hungry. A final entry ends mid-sentence: "Last night it whispered to me–" and then only smeared ink stains, as if someone tore the pages in fright.

CHAPTER 8

THE GRINNING SPECTER



Marla hears it before she sees it: soft giggles echoing from behind the trunk. She spins around, lantern held high—and there it is: a pale face with hollow eyes and a grin splitting cheek to cheek. It tilts its head, inches from hers, and breathes, "Play with me."